Shinnosuke and the Fire Monster

By Palak Kamthan

Shinnosuke was having the best morning ever. He had his favorite Action Mask figurine, and he was building a giant castle out of colorful blocks in the middle of the living room. "To the rescue!" he cheered, imagining he was a great hero protecting the city from giant monsters.

Suddenly, a tiny whirlwind appeared. It was his little sister, Himawari. With one happy giggle and a clumsy crawl, she bumped into the base of the tower. Crash! The blocks tumbled everywhere, and Action Mask was buried under a pile of plastic bricks.

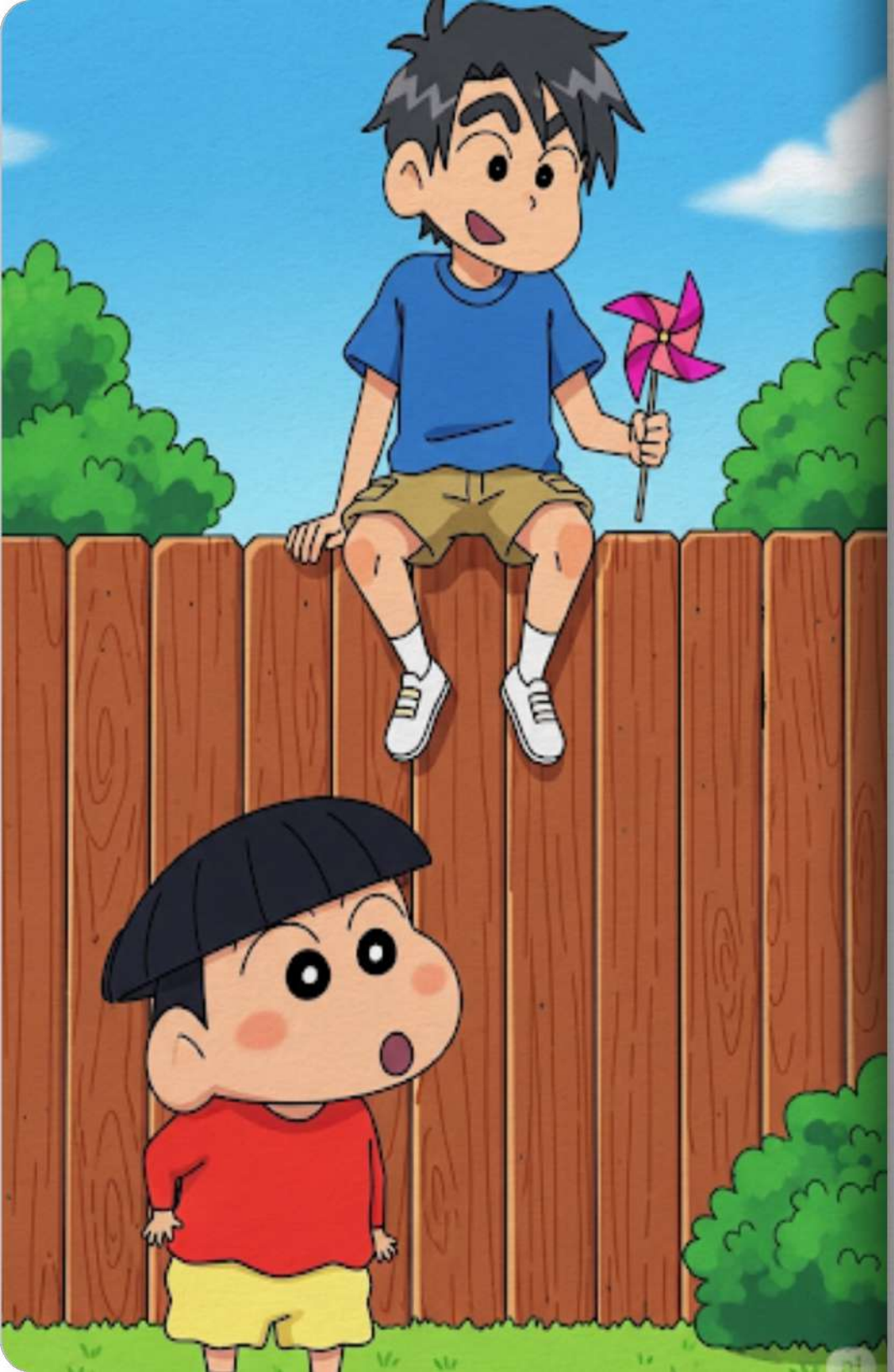
Shinnosuke felt a strange heat in his chest. It started small, like a tiny spark, but it grew into a roaring fire. His face felt hot, his hands turned into tight balls, and he wanted to stomp the floor until it cracked. The Fire Monster had arrived.

His mother, Misae, rushed into the room to see what the noise was. "Oh dear, Shinnosuke, it was just an accident," she said, reaching out to pat his shoulder. But the Fire Monster inside him didn't want a pat. "No! It's not fair!" he shouted, pulling away.

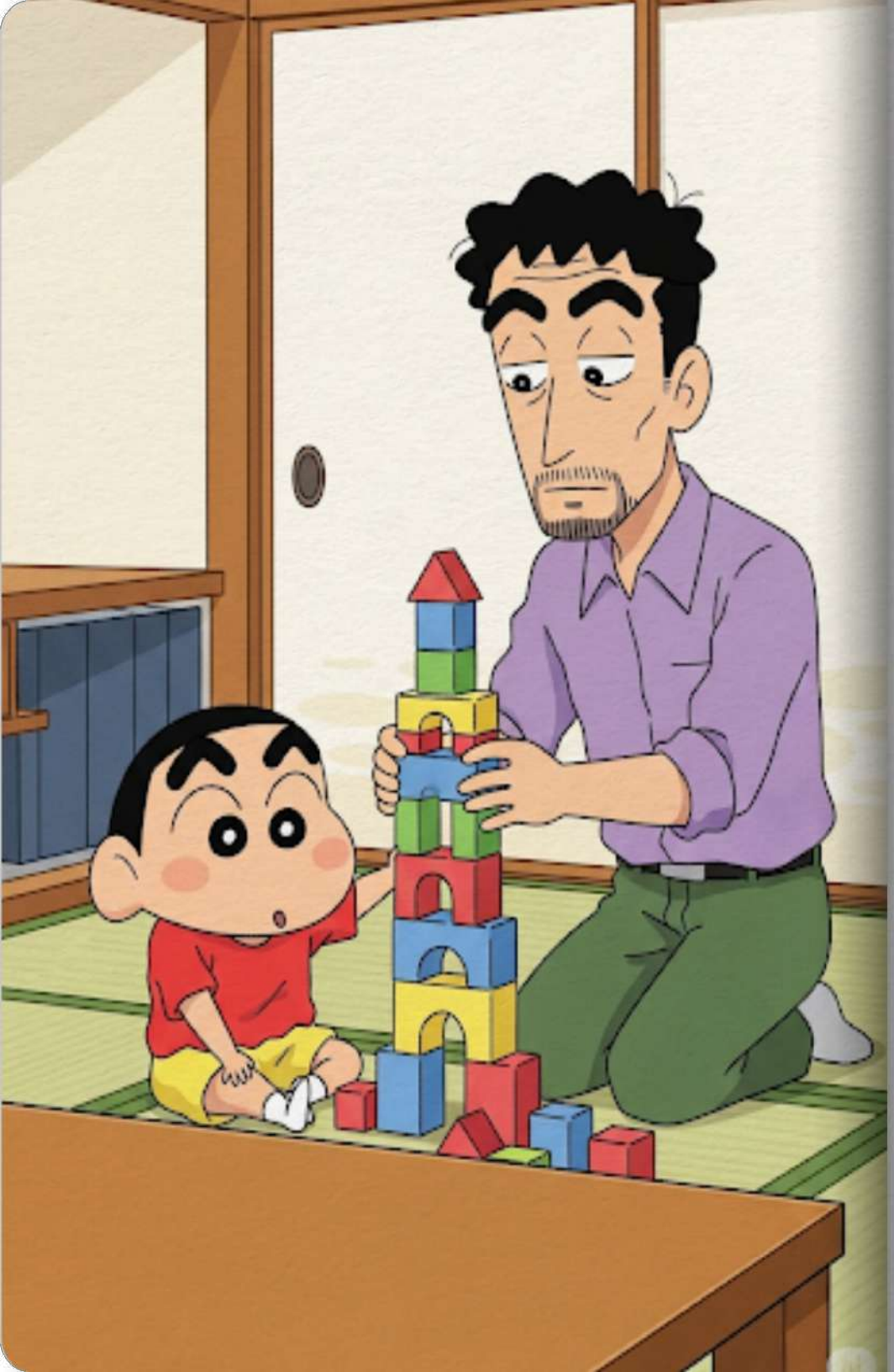
Shinnosuke stomped out the back door and into the garden. Every step felt like a heavy "THUD" against the earth. He felt like he was made of hot lava, and he thought that anything he touched might melt from the sheer heat of his anger.

In the corner of the yard, Shiro the dog was napping in the shade. He opened one eye and wagged his tail slowly. Shiro didn't care about broken towers or loud noises. He just looked at Shinnosuke with soft, peaceful eyes, waiting for a belly rub.

"Shiro, I'm a volcano," Shinnosuke whispered, sitting down on the grass. He told Shiro all about the tower and how the Fire Monster was making his tummy feel tight and his head feel cloudy. Shiro listened quietly and then gently licked Shinnosuke's hand.



"That Fire Monster visits everyone sometimes," a voice called out. Shinnosuke looked up toward the fence. It was Sora, an older boy from the neighborhood. Sora was sitting on the wooden planks, holding a bright pinwheel that spun slowly in the breeze.



The heat in Shinnosuke's chest began to fade away. He didn't feel like a volcano anymore; he just felt like himself. He went back inside and found his dad, Hiroshi. Together, they started building a new, even bigger castle, and this time, they built a small fence around it just for Himawari.